

CASE ID: 200607710020

EPISODE NAME: Canada Honors Dalai Lama

2006/07/26 - 2007/07/26

Sender: China (710)

Target: Canada (20)

Issue: Terminate Support of Non-State Actors (10)

Final Outcome: Stalemate in the Threat Stage (4)

Narrative:

On 2006/06/22, The Canadian government bestowed honorary citizenship to The Dalai Lama.¹ This was a rare honor which had only been bestowed upon two other people in the past: South Africa's first president Nelson Mandela, and the Swedish diplomat Raoul Wallenberg, who saved thousands of Jews from the Holocaust.²

On 2006/07/26, Zang Weidong, minister-counselor at the Chinese embassy, suggested that Canada's actions could result in economic sanctions by China: "We have 1.3 billion population and we are developing and the future for China is bright and China has a big market and we hope we can co-operate with all the countries in the world...But if some problems or troubles always appear or emerge in the bilateral relationship, certainly the other relationships certainly will be hurt, so we have to manage all the differences and difficulties with caution."³ Asked if China was leveling a threat, Zang smiled and said, "'I don't think it's a threat. I'm just trying to make things clearer. It is a clear fact and very easy to be seen.'"^{4 5}

The threats of possible economic sanctions by China were left unfulfilled.

¹ "Honouring Dalai Lama could have economic cost, China warns." *The Canadian Press*, July 27th, 2006. <https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/honouring-dalai-lama-could-have-economic-cost-china-warns-1.600735>.

² *Ibid*.

³ "China warns Canada on award for Dalai Lama." *NBC News*, June 26th, 2006. <https://www.nbcnews.com/id/wbna14045372>.

⁴ *Ibid*

⁵ Fuchs, Andreas, and Klann, Nils-Hendrik. "Paying a visit: The Dalai Lama effect on international trade." *Journal of International Economics*, Volume 91, Issue 1, 2013, pp. 164-177.